

ALEJANDRO VALADEZ

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SUMMARY

IMSA sophomore focused on aerospace engineering, finance, and business. Led a model rocket team in an Airbus-partnered program in Toulouse, has run a seasonal food business since 2023, and builds software tools in TypeScript and Python.

EDUCATION

Illinois Mathematics and Science Academy (IMSA)

Aug 2026 – Present

Class of 2029, Sophomore

Aurora, IL

Illinois' statewide residential public academy for students advanced in mathematics and science. Admitted for sophomore year.

- Coursework: Chemistry, Geometry I/II, Methods in Scientific Inquiry, French III, Literary Explorations I, Financial Empowerment Class.

Jones College Prep

Aug 2025 – Jun 2026

Freshman Year

Chicago, IL

Selective-enrollment public high school; commuted two hours a day.

- GPA: 4.0 unweighted / 4.8 weighted.

AEROSPACE ENGINEERING

CIEE Aerospace Engineering Program, in partnership with Airbus

Jun 2026 – Jul 2026

Scholarship Recipient; Rocket Team Lead

Toulouse, France

Month-long summer program with daily classes taught by three doctorate-level instructors, held with INSA Toulouse, a leading French engineering university.

- Led my team through 8 workshops to design a model rocket in OpenRocket, then build and launch it.
- When our parachute failed a bench test, the team reinforced the heat shield and upgraded the suspension cord; the rocket flew straight on launch day.

LEADERSHIP EXPERIENCE

Student Government Association, Jones College Prep

Sep 2025 – Jun 2026

Elected Vice President, Class of 2029

Chicago, IL

Officer on the elected board that represents the freshman class and runs its events and fundraising.

- Ran class board meetings, brought classmates' ideas to the board, and wrote meeting, mid-year, and end-of-year reports to administration.
- Helped plan and run 6 events, including a Winter Movie Night, a Valentine's card fundraiser, and photobooths.
- Worked with administration to get the school's first underclassmen Spring Dance approved; the dance raised \$3,000 for the class.

IMSA PROMISE Program

Aug 2026 – Present

Tutor, 9th Grade

Aurora, IL

IMSA's Saturday and summer STEM enrichment program for students working toward the academy. Completed it as a student from Feb 2023 to Jun 2026.

- Tutor 9th-grade students during Saturday sessions, about 6 hours a week.

Student Government Association, Ebinger Elementary

Sep 2023 – Jun 2025

8th Grade Class President (2024–25); Member (2023–24)

Chicago, IL

- Organized 3 school dances: a Hawaiian-themed dance, a Halloween dance, and a winter formal.
- Set up restaurant partnerships: customers who mentioned the school got 15% off, and 15% of those sales went back to the class.

Ebinger Elementary Musicals

Dec 2023 – Mar 2025

Stage Manager, *The Lion King Jr.* and *Beauty and the Beast Jr.*

Chicago, IL

- Coordinated the sound and lights crews through rehearsals and live performances for two productions.

ENTREPRENEURSHIP & FINANCE

Shaved Ice & Caramel Apple Stand

2023 – Present

Founder and Owner

Chicago, IL

Seasonal food business: shaved ice in the summer, caramel apple cups in the fall.

- Run sourcing, inventory, pricing, setup, storage, and marketing.
- Sell shaved ice at \$2 a cup against about \$0.60 in cost, for about \$150 a day in profit; caramel apple slice cups sell for \$5 and bring in about \$200 a day in profit.

- Built 5,000+ followers across Instagram, Facebook, Snapchat, and Nextdoor, backed by yard signs and flags around the neighborhood.
 - Sold part of the business to my younger brother in 2026; he now runs it day to day while I keep a share of the profits.
- Personal Investing and Options Trading** Since age 10
Self-directed investor
- Hold VOO as a long-term core position with QQQ as the higher-risk holding; day and swing trade options, mostly calls on TSLA, AAPL, and GOOGL.
 - Earned about \$15,000 in lifetime trading gains, net positive; after losing more than \$5,000 to emotional trades, set a take-profit and stop-loss on every position.

PROJECTS & RESEARCH

Canvas LMS MCP Server
Creator | TypeScript, Node.js, Model Context Protocol, Canvas API

Open source, MIT
github.com/f1alej/canvas-mcp

- Built an MCP server that lets Claude read Canvas courses, assignments, rubrics, discussions, submissions, and .docx attachments, and submit work from the chat.

Le Grand Tour
Sole Developer | TypeScript, Vercel, Roblox, Luau

Fall 2026
le-grand-tour.vercel.app

French III class project; I built every part of it.

- Built a multiplayer French-review board game for 2 to 6 players who play from their phones, first as a website and then as a published Roblox game scripted in Luau.

Runaway Ramps: Slowing Down With Science
Independent Researcher | Experimental Design, Data Analysis

Aug 2024 – May 2025
Published on ResearchGate

Physics study modeled on the runaway truck ramps built along steep highways.

- Built a ramp-and-RC-car rig and measured stopping distance on 4 surfaces: gravel (0.41 m), sand (0.48 m), concrete (0.84 m), and glass (1.21 m).
- Won local and regional Gold Awards, advanced from the Chicago Exhibition of Student STEM Research, and earned a Silver Award at the IJAS State Exposition.

Avenues to Kindness
Project Lead, IB MYP Community Project

Aug 2024 – May 2025
Chicago, IL

- Partnered with a disability-independence organization to design and deliver 90 handmade cards to its residents.
- Earned the Tim Heneghan S.O.A.R. Award (1 of 2 in the graduating class) and the IB Principled Learner Award for disability advocacy.

HONORS & AWARDS

Quarterfinalist, Northwestern Policy Debate City Championship	Mar 2026
1st Place, Student Video Team Math Contest, Jones College Prep	Nov 2025
SEAMS Diligent Scholar Award, Illinois Mathematics and Science Academy	Jun 2025
State Seal of Biliteracy in Spanish, Illinois State Board of Education	Jun 2025
Silver Award, 98th Annual State Exposition, Illinois Junior Academy of Science (IJAS)	May 2025

ACTIVITIES

IMSA (2026 – Present): AEROSpace Club, IMSA Society of Engineers, Physics Club, TALENT (entrepreneurship program), Financial Empowerment Class, Speech Team, IMSA Student Productions, Alma Latina, Intramural Sports

Jones College Prep (2025 – 26): Rocketry Club, Engineering Club, Artificial Intelligence Leaders, Future Business Leaders of America, Policy Debate Team, Math Team, Red Cross Club, Mexican American Cultural Exploration and Expression

SKILLS & LANGUAGES

Software: Python, TypeScript, JavaScript, React, Next.js, Node.js, Tailwind CSS, Luau (Roblox), Git/GitHub, MCP, Vercel

Engineering & Research: OpenRocket, experimental design, data analysis

Finance: Options trading, ETF investing, risk management with take-profit and stop-loss orders, TradingView, Robinhood

Languages: English (native), Spanish (bilingual, State Seal of Biliteracy), French (intermediate, French III)